

Leave Ready, Return Clean

Departure card 3 of 3

The legal and safety gates around every trip

STATIC PAPER IS NOT THE LAW

Immediately before fishing, use Wisconsin DNR's current searchable regulations for the exact water and species. Check season, length and bag limits, method, license, and local posted boating rules. A total daily bag limit and a waterbody daily limit are separate constraints.

Before leaving home

LEGAL

- Current license for each required angler
- Pine WBIC 779200 or North WBIC 850800 selected
- Water- and species-specific rules checked today
- Current fish-consumption advice checked if harvesting
- Launch and local ordinances checked

CONDITIONS

- Forecast, radar, wind, air and water temperature
- Cancel for thunderstorm risk
- Route and return time left with a shore contact
- Crew, load, and plan within capacity plate
- Fuel/charge and daylight margin

At the boat

Wear	Fitted, serviceable, USCG-approved life jacket for each person. Carrying one cannot help if it is unreachable after a fall.
Carry	Wearable PFD for every person; immediately accessible throwable device on vessels 16 ft or longer; communication, whistle, first aid, lights, and safety gear appropriate to the boat.
Control	Sober operator; balanced load; no passenger on gunwale or seatback; slow-no-wake and posted rules observed.
Escape	Know the nearest safe landing from every part of the route. At thunder or threatening weather, leave early.

At the ramp after fishing

Inspect · Remove · Drain · Never move live fish

1. Inspect boat, trailer, anchor, lines, net, waders, and fishing gear.
2. Remove attached plants, animals, and mud before highway transport.
3. Drain boat, motor, bilge, livewell, buckets, and fishing equipment.
4. Never move live fish away from the waterbody. Put unwanted bait in trash; follow the current DNR exceptions for dealer minnows.

Live authorities — check, do not memorize

Fishing rules: <https://dnr.wisconsin.gov/topic/fishing/regulations>
Consumption: <https://dnr.wisconsin.gov/topic/Fishing/consumption>
Boat/PFD: <https://dnr.wisconsin.gov/topic/Boat/safety>
AIS/bait: <https://dnr.wisconsin.gov/topic/Invasives/boat>

Sources checked 2026-07-26. This card intentionally omits numeric harvest limits because they change. The live authority and posted local rules control.